

Rare Children of the Dreaming

The chimerical world of the Dreaming can also harbor strange and unusual creatures, as well as supernatural beings that can see and interact with changelings and chimerical beings. Those creatures include *Bygones*, powerful monsters and fantastical beasts that have escaped into the Dreaming to become powerful and wild away from the crushing hands of the Banal world. These creatures may once have been chimera, or else were something else entirely. Regardless, they represent creatures from a time long ago when monsters strode the earth, their very presence striking fear into the hearts of humans and fae alike. Many questing motleys leave freeholds to tackle the threat of a chimerical monster such as a dragon, only to find they are facing a Bygone dragon hundreds of years old instead of some child's imaginary playmate gone wrong.

While many changelings give the other supernatural beings of the World of Darkness, known to changelings as *Prodigals*, a wide berth, outliers from groups like House Beaumayn and House Scathach are known to interact with them. Changelings must remain wary, however, as their very Glamour-fueled essence, as well as their bodies and blood, are rare treats for the more predatory Prodigals out there.

One legendary group often sought in the Dreaming is the *Síocháin*, comprising changelings who have managed to achieve balance between Glamour and Banality, and have therefore achieved immortality. Though long since considered a myth, the impending fear of a rapidly-dwindling supply of Glamour and a colder, more Banal world has sent people seeking the *Síocháin*'s aid. Nobles have sponsored great searches, to no avail. The *Síocháin* have remained elusive, enigmatic, and solitary, unwilling to share their secrets no matter the reasoning or the cost. Still, their presence is a comforting reminder that perhaps changelings can transcend their mortality even when locked into the bond with their mortal forms.

Additionally, rare kiths of changeling from opposite sides of the world may find themselves drawn together within the Dreaming, for reasons that only the Dreaming itself could answer. The more populous kiths can find themselves alongside fae they may not have known existed, such as the alien merfolk or the Hsien of the East. These *Gallain* can have much to teach a curious changeling, but they bring with them cultures and traditions that are unfamiliar, but ought to still be respected.

And in the shadows stalk the *Thallain*, twisted nightmare versions of Kithain. These terrifying dark versions of trolls, *sidhe*, and more are as much equal children of the Dreaming as the Kithain themselves, and stand as a harsh reminder of the dangerous dance to stay ahead of their dark side.

Dangers In A Darkening World

The natural forces of a quickly-darkening world are not the only challenges a changeling faces. Though changelings must struggle to find and nurture the creative spark in the world, the chill of Banality pales in comparison to the dangers of changeling society or enemies in the Dreaming.

First is the natural infighting that turns changeling against changeling. The ongoing conflict between the nobility and commoners takes its toll, and many changelings are Undone — or even destroyed — with horrific cold iron, just like in the ancient wars of the courts. With so many leaders locked away from their people, unaware of how bad things have gotten in Concordia, commoners mutter about the Accordance War and the lives they lost as perhaps a better alternative than slowly freezing to death under the weight of the Endless Night.

As changelings struggle to find an accord among themselves, enemies from within are joined by horrors from without. Wild chimera can wreak disasters upon unsuspecting changeling. Prodigals encroach on changeling territory, and even hunt Kithain for their power or their blood. Even more sinister are the *Dauntain*, Kithain who embrace Banality and dedicate their lives to stamping out the fae wherever they are. They join the *Thallain*, as well as dark kin called *Adhene* and even mortal authorities who are aware of supernatural beings, as forces that can destroy a changeling, or even an entire freehold.

The Courts

Duality is core to the Kithain experience — Earth and the Dreaming, Glamour and Banality, dreams and nightmares. Duality is at the heart of their philosophy both on an individual and societal level. The twin pillars of Seelie and Unseelie support and influence the actions of all changelings regardless of kith or station. The tension between the two is the tension between light and shadow, summer and winter, and hierarchy and individuality. These twin ideologies, and by extension all Kithain, are caught in a neverending struggle for dominance.

The concepts of Seelie and Unseelie have their own dichotomy in changeling society. Every Kithain has both a Seelie and an Unseelie Legacy within her. These Legacies are archetypes that serve as the core of her personality. One is dominant, while the other subconsciously influences her.

The Seelie and Unseelie Courts are external political philosophies. Each court has a code — its statement of beliefs. While all changelings are drawn to a court thanks to their Legacies, a court's code is not innate. Every changeling has her own personal interpretation of her court's code. Rarely does a changeling claim membership in a court that doesn't match her Legacy, but cases exist of a changeling following an Unseelie Legacy while attempting to uphold the Seelie Code, and vice versa.

Through the Ages

The courts have been established for longer than the Kithain have records. Even in their most ancient legends of the Mythic Age, the courts play a prominent role. Scholars of faerie history debate how the courts were originally founded. Some believe the codes of the two courts were handed down by the Tuatha de Danaan themselves. Others claim a great gathering of fae convened to determine stewardship of the Dreaming shortly after the Tuatha departed the world. Driven by their Legacies, two irreconcilable views emerged. Eventually, these